

# SERAFIN O. GARGANTIEL III

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## EDUCATION

### University of Illinois Chicago (UIC)

August 2022 – May 2026

B.S. Computer Science, Software Engineering Concentration · GPA: 3.42 · Dean's List (Spring & Fall 2023)

**Coursework:** Software Engineering (React), Data Structures (C++), Database Systems (SQL), Data Science, UI Interface Design, Mobile Development, Software Design (Java)

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Languages:** C++ · Python · Java · SQL · React · HTML/CSS

**Tools:** Git/GitHub · VS Code · Linux CLI · PostgreSQL · Jupyter Notebook · Unity · Tableau · Android Studio

## EXPERIENCE

### CyberSecurity Student – CodePath CYB 102

Feb 2026 – Present

CodePath · Remote

- Completing project-based cybersecurity program covering vulnerability identification, threat modeling, and defensive security strategies.
- Applying secure coding principles and authentication best practices to mitigate injection attacks and access control flaws.

### Airport Service Assistant

Jul – Aug 2025

Prospect Airport Services · O'Hare International Airport, Chicago, IL

- Assisted passengers requiring mobility support; coordinated with gate agents and airline staff in high-traffic, time-sensitive environment.

### Data Analytics Program Student

Aug – Nov 2024

Global Career Accelerator / UIC · Remote

- Completed advanced data wrangling program using SQL, Python, Tableau, and Jupyter Notebook; earned SQL & Python Specialist certifications.
- Delivered data-driven analyses for real Intel and GRAMMYS projects; produced reports with actionable business recommendations.

### Backend Developer – SparkHacks Hackathon

Feb 2025

UIC SparkHacks · Chicago, IL

- Built Python/SQL chatbot with a 5-person team to help new UIC students navigate campus resources in 24-hour hackathon.

## PROJECTS

### Amazon Product Reviews Semantic Search System

Sep – Dec 2025

PostgreSQL · Python · C++ · Vector Databases

- Designed vector data pipeline for 50,000+ reviews enabling semantic similarity search; reduced query latency ~35% through indexing.
- Architected full PostgreSQL schema from a self-designed ER diagram; led database design in a 3-person team.

### Wild Realms Immersive Wildlife Simulator

Sep – Dec 2025

React · Three.js · Google Earth API

- Built interactive 3D simulator spanning 6 global biomes with 10+ species; implemented Desert and Tundra biomes with discovery mode.

### Three Card Poker GUI Game

Oct – Nov 2024

Java · JavaFX · CSS

- Developed full poker game with dealer AI, betting mechanics (Ante, Pair Plus, Play), and 100% correct win/loss detection across all unit tests.

### UI/UX Inventory Management Platform

Feb 2026 – Present

React · Git/GitHub · HTML/CSS

- Building React inventory app for crafters in a 5-person team; informed by 3+ user interviews to improve tracking workflows.

## ATHLETICS & LEADERSHIP

### Semi-Professional Soccer Player

Mar 2026 – Present

Berber City FC (UPSL Tier 4) & Machu Picchu FC (GCSL Major Division) · Chicago, IL

- Accepted onto two concurrent semi-pro rosters through competitive tryouts; balancing 3–4 training sessions/week with full academic load.

### Competitive Distance Runner – UIC Running Club

2022 – 2025

University of Illinois at Chicago

- Chicago 13.1 Half Marathon (Jul 2025): 1:37:12, top 17% overall (765/9,542); Shamrock Shuffle 8K: 33:29; Hot Chocolate 15K: 1:05:55 (7:05/mi), 10th in M20–24.

### Member – SHPE & Filipinos In Alliance (FIA)

2024 – Present

UIC · Chicago, IL

- Attended SHPE National Convention 2025; networked with engineers at Lenovo, John Deere, United Airlines, and Epsilon.
- Athletics Intern at FIA; performed at Midwest Filipino American Summit 2025 after 4 weeks of rehearsals.

## CERTIFICATIONS & AWARDS

**SQL Specialist** (Oct 2024) · **Python Specialist** (Dec 2024) · **Intercultural Skills** (Dec 2024) · **UIC Dean's List** Spring & Fall 2023 · **Intel Sustainability Data Analysis** (Nov 2024) · **GRAMMYS Audience Analysis** (Dec 2024)